

SPUTNIK 1

Satellite

Launched by Russia on 4 October 1957, Sputnik 1 was the first man-made object to orbit Earth. The size of a beach ball, this metal satellite circled the world for more than two months before burning up when it re-entered our planet's atmosphere. Sputnik 1's launch triggered a "space race" between Russia and the United States.

DATA FILE



SIZE: 58 cm (23 in) in diameter



DATE OF LAUNCH: 4 October 1957



MISSION DURATION: 92 days
(de-orbited)



SPACE AGENCY: Russian
space program

The 2.9 m (9.5 ft)
antennae sent the
first signals from
orbit down to Earth

The United States
launched their
first satellite,
Explorer, four
months later.